



AS A MIDDLE AND DEATH-OVER ENFORCER, MAYANK WOULD, IN THEORY, ALLOW INDIA TO USE JASPRIT BUMRAH MORE FLUIDLY THROUGHOUT THE INNINGS

Tall order: Mayank also brings a third advantage: his height. Standing at 6 feet 3 inches, he releases the ball from a considerable height.

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he needs to build on his IPL start. He could provide India with the option of a middle and death-over enforcer. He would, in theory, allow India to use Jasprit Bumrah more fluidly throughout the innings. LSG has used Mayank in a similar role, with five of his six wickets so far coming between overs 7 and 16. "Mayank is not giving you the lengths to hit out of the ground. All sixes against him will be behind the wicket only; hitting him through long-on and long-off will be a challenge for any batsman. Even in this IPL, batters who have tried to hit Mayank through mid-wicket or mid-on have gotten out

because their timing is awry due to the high pace. Mayank is also able to vary the lengths without changing his speeds, which is commendable," Sekar pointed out.

Much focus will also be on the kinds of pitches used in the World Cup. It has been a long time since the West Indies has been a fast bowlers' paradise while the pitches in the USA could be high-scoring. Mayank can bowl extremely fast in the middle overs, even when conditions are not necessarily favourable for seam and swing, complementing Bumrah's

guile. Accuracy is key, of course. RCB captain Faf du Plessis touched upon this aspect after his side bore the brunt of Mayank's pace. "It was impressive to see his pace. But more impressive for me was his ability to control length and bowl with some good discipline. That's more impressive — pace combined with accuracy."

Surendra Bhavé, another national selector, spoke about the risks of a broken radar, especially for someone who bowls that fast.

"Recent trends show that bowlers exceeding 150 kmph often struggle with accuracy. The selectors will observe Mayank closely during this IPL to assess his performance and gauge his fitness level.

Given his pace, monitoring his fitness is essential, as there's a higher risk of injury when bowling at such speeds. However, Mayank appears to be in excellent shape and focused on his game," Bhavé said. "From the limited exposure I've had to him, Mayank doesn't seem to be a bowler who concedes too many runs while bowling very fast. With his pace, precision becomes crucial; otherwise, he can be expensive. It's natural for bowlers to get hit occasionally in T20 cricket, but Mayank's ability to trouble top players with his pace is noteworthy. His fielding efforts seem commendable as well," Bhavé added.

But one thing India will want to keep an eye on is Mayank's performance at the death. During this IPL, LSG has not used him in the final overs yet. His lengths in the first two